A PRACTITIONER'S PROGRAM

HR AI Literacy Curriculum

Four modules over 4-6 weeks: 7 hours of sessions plus async practice, roughly 8 hours in all. Synthetic exercises in approved tools.

4
MODULES

7
SESSION HOURS

All
PEOPLE TEAM MEMBERS

Built by Elle Helvig · github.com/ellehelvig/hr-ai-transformation-playbook

Program at a glance

What this curriculum delivers and how it is structured.

TOTAL TIME

~8 hours

7 session hours + async practice

FORMAT

Workshop + lab

Async reading + hands-on practice

AUDIENCE

All People Team

HRBPs, HR Ops, HR Tech, leadership

PREREQUISITE

None

Approved tools; synthetic data in every lab

The four modules

Each module builds on the previous. Together they take an HR professional from zero understanding to drafting their own use case spec.

01	**How AI works** *What HR professionals actually need to know*	**90 min** *Workshop*
02	**Using AI in your daily HR work** *Prompts, labs, and the verify-before-use discipline*	**2 hours** *Workshop + lab*
03	**Governance, ethics, responsible use** *Legal risk, scenarios, risk assessment*	**90 min** *Workshop*
04	**Building and scaling AI use cases** *Prioritization, design, deployment, scale*	**2 hours** *Workshop + project*

MODULE

01

How AI works

What HR professionals actually need to know

90 minutes

Workshop format

Foundational concepts: how LLMs work, hallucination, the rule-based to agentic spectrum, and why prompt quality drives output quality.

Learning objectives

After this session, participants will be able to:

1. Explain the difference between traditional automation and generative AI.
2. Describe why AI "hallucinates" and how to mitigate it in HR contexts.
3. Identify which HR tasks are good candidates for AI assistance and which are not.

Session outline

90 minutes

0:00–0:10	Opening	What do you already believe about AI? Quick poll + discussion.
0:10–0:30	Concept	How LLMs work: without the jargon. Facilitator presentation.
0:30–0:45	Concept	Hallucination, confidence, and why AI makes things up.
0:45–1:05	Exercise	Spot the hallucination, identify errors in AI-generated HR content.
1:05–1:20	Discussion	Where should HR use AI? Where should we be cautious?
1:20–1:30	Wrap-up	Homework: try one AI tool before next session.

Three concepts every HR professional needs

What LLMs actually are

Large language models predict the next most likely word given context. They don't "know" things the way a database knows things, they pattern-match against training data. This is why they can sound authoritative while being wrong.

The rule-based to agentic spectrum

Rules → Assist / Augment → Agent. Use rules when they reliably answer the task. A person owns HR decisions. Multi-step model action must earn autonomy through evidence and governance.

Prompts define task boundaries

Clear prompts help, but output also depends on the model, sources, workflow controls and verification. A good prompt does not establish accuracy or safe HR judgment.

MODULE

02

Using AI in your daily HR work

Prompts, labs, and the verify-before-use discipline

2 hours

Workshop + hands-on lab

Use approved tools and fictional HR scenarios. Run two library prompts, evaluate the outputs and iterate. Do not upload employee or confidential employer data.

Learning objectives

After this session, participants will be able to:

1. Write effective prompts for HR use cases using the four-elements framework.
2. Use the prompt library for at least three HR workflows.
3. Identify when to use AI, when to verify AI output, and when not to use it.

Session outline

2 hours including lab

0:00–0:15	Share-back	What did you try from Module 1 homework? What happened?
0:15–0:45	Concept	Prompt engineering for HR: the four elements of a good prompt.
0:45–1:10	Demo	Live demo: onboarding plan, performance review draft, policy Q&A.
1:10–1:50	Lab	Run 2 library prompts using synthetic HR scenarios in approved tools.
1:50–2:00	Debrief	What surprised you? What didn't work?

The four elements of an effective HR prompt

Define the task and verify the result. A role is not professional authority.

1

ROLE

Define the task perspective, such as drafting support for an HRBP. A role instruction does not grant professional authority.

2

CONTEXT

Use fictional role, tenure, team and situation details. Keep employee, candidate, compensation and confidential employer data out of the lab.

3

TASK

State clearly what you want it to produce. One output per prompt. "Draft a..." is clearer than "Help me with..."

4

CONSTRAINTS

Define length, tone, format, exclusions and required verification. Check whether the output follows them.

The verify-before-use rule

A heuristic introduced in Module 2 and reinforced throughout the program.

POLICY DETAILS	Always verify against source system before sharing.
LEGAL REQUIREMENTS	Always verify with Legal before relying on.
FACTUAL CLAIMS	Spot-check against a known source.
TONE AND CONTENT	Always read before sending. AI doesn't know your audience.

MODULE

03

Governance, ethics, responsible use

Legal risk, scenarios, and the risk assessment template

90 minutes

Workshop format

Practice risk decisions using fictional scenarios. Invite different perspectives. Complete governance approvals before any real-work pilot.

Learning objectives

After this session, participants will be able to:

1. Apply the organization's AI use policy to real HR scenarios.
2. Identify the key legal risk areas in HR AI: bias, privacy, employment law.
3. Complete a basic risk assessment for a new use case.

Key legal risk areas

Risk questions, not a complete legal reference. Use the dated Key dates for HR in the playbook; verify scope and obligations with Legal.

Bias and disparate impact

Examine historical labels, features, selection effects and group outcomes. Assess adverse impact and corrective action. Ask Legal which tests, audits and review cadence apply.

State and local AI hiring laws

Hiring requirements differ by jurisdiction, tool and decision. Confirm notice, consent, assessments, effective dates and transition rules using the linked primary sources.

GDPR and CCPA

Determine which privacy and automated-decision rights apply. Verify purpose, data minimization, retention, access and routes for human review with Privacy and Legal.

The "AI as a manager" trap

Monitoring, evaluating or scoring employees raises legal and trust risks. Assess transparency, challenge routes and accountable human decisions; disclosure alone is not a safeguard.

Scenario practice

Groups of 3-4 discuss: Is this use appropriate? What are the risks? What would you change?

A

SCENARIO

An AI tool automatically rejects resumes with gaps of more than 6 months without showing them to a recruiter.

B

SCENARIO

An HRBP uses an AI writing assistant to draft a PIP for an employee, then reviews and edits it before sharing with the manager.

C

SCENARIO

People Analytics builds an attrition risk model that scores all employees monthly and shares the scores directly with managers.

D

SCENARIO

An AI chatbot answers benefits questions for employees. It sometimes gives incorrect information but flags that users should confirm with HR.

MODULE

04

Building and scaling AI use cases

From idea to deployment to scale

2 hours

Workshop + project

Participants apply the prioritization matrix to their team's top ideas and draft a one-page use case spec for their highest-ranked use case.

Learning objectives

After this session, participants will be able to:

1. Apply the prioritization matrix to identify your team's highest-value AI use cases.
2. Define a use case with clear success metrics and governance requirements.
3. Draft a basic implementation plan for a low-complexity use case.

The use case lifecycle

From idea to scale, with iteration baked in.

01	02	03	04	05	06
Discover	**Prioritize**	**Design**	**Pilot**	**Evaluate**	**Scale**
What problem are we solving? Who feels it most?	Use the matrix. Don't skip this.	Inputs, outputs, human review gates, metrics, fallback.	Small scope, high observation. 4-8 weeks.	Did it work? For whom? What didn't?	Expand with pilot lessons baked in.

↻ *iterate*

One-page use case spec template

What participants complete for their team's top-ranked use case.

- **Use case name**
- **Problem it solves (1 sentence)**
- **Who benefits and how**
- **Approach: Rules / Augment / Assist / Human-led / Analytics**
- **Data needed**
- **Human review gate**
- **Success metric(s)**
- **What could go wrong**
- **Governance requirements (from risk assessment)**
- **Pilot owner, baseline and expand / pause / stop gate**

Use synthetic exercises first. Before a real pilot, confirm governance approval, accountable owners, review cost and adoption evidence.

Assessment & recognition

Proposed internal acknowledgment; not accreditation or proof of competence.

STANDARD COMPLETION

HR AI Practitioner

Optional acknowledgment after four modules and hands-on activities. Completion does not establish safe independent HR AI use.

Requirements:

- Attend all 4 modules
- Complete Module 2 lab
- Participate in Module 3 scenarios

OPTIONAL EXTENSION

HR AI Champion

A proposed informal internal designation for peer enablement. It requires an accountable program owner.

Additional requirement:

Complete a full use case spec and present it to the HR Technology team.

Facilitator notes

Proposed delivery guidance. Effectiveness and adoption still need evaluation.

MODULE 3	Allow time for risk discussion and different perspectives. Governance approvals precede real-work pilots.
MODULE 2 LAB	Protect hands-on practice time. Evaluate errors, review effort and learning rather than assuming the lab is effective.
CASE STUDIES	Adapt fictional scenarios to relevant HR workflows. Do not use identifiable employee or confidential employer information.
FACILITATION	Invite a range of views. Track adoption barriers, reviewer burden and evidence for expanding, pausing or stopping.

THIS CURRICULUM IS PART OF

HR AI Transformation Playbook

A field guide for HR and People Teams designing responsible AI programs: use cases, prompt drafts, governance templates, workflow patterns, evaluation tools and a transformation roadmap.

REPOSITORY

github.com/ellehelvig/hr-ai-transformation-playbook

CONNECT

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Built by Elle Helvig